MVPCompanion

RESOURCE 3.1

Is Your App Idea Ready for MVP Definition?

A guided self-assessment before you turn an idea into a structured MVP specification.

This worksheet helps you assess whether the key uncertainties around your idea have been clarified enough to begin MVP definition. It is a reflection tool, not a certification: gaps are useful signals for what to investigate next.

How to use this assessment

- For each statement, select the status that best describes your current position.
- Label what you know: E = Evidence, H = Hypothesis, D = Derived, O = Open question.
- If a statement is not supported yet, record the gap and a practical next action.
- A high score is not proof of demand or product success.

Readiness statements

1. I can describe the problem without prescribing an app or feature.	Select...
2. I can identify a specific primary user who experiences this problem.	Select...
3. I understand the user's context, alternatives, and workarounds.	Select...
4. I can state the desired user outcome and why it matters.	Select...
5. I can explain the value proposition without listing features.	Select...
6. I can describe the product's central object and key relationships, provisionally.	Select...
7. I can describe the Core Jobs the user needs to accomplish.	Select...
8. I distinguish evidence from hypotheses and open questions.	Select...

Readiness Check · Continued

Assess scope, experience, learning, and feasibility without jumping straight to implementation.

9. I can prioritize Core Jobs rather than starting with a feature list.	Select...
10. I can explain what the MVP includes and explicitly excludes.	Select...
11. I can describe the core user journey and first moment of value.	Select...
12. I have initial ways to test the most important assumptions.	Select...
13. I can name observable signals or metrics that indicate progress.	Select...
14. Major technical boundaries, dependencies, and risks are visible.	Select...
15. I know which questions must be answered before committing to build.	Select...

Your biggest readiness gaps

Which statements are weakest, and why?

What evidence would increase your confidence?

Next actions: who will do what, and by when?

Interpret Your Results

Use the pattern of answers—not a single total score—to decide what to clarify next.

Overall judgment

This is a qualitative readiness check. There is no validated numeric threshold. One unresolved foundational issue—such as an unclear problem or primary user—may matter more than several strong answers.

READY TO BEGIN MVP DEFINITION

Most foundational answers are clear enough to begin structured clarification. Keep assumptions visible and expect to revise decisions.

PARTLY READY — CLARIFY FIRST

Some foundations exist, but important uncertainties remain. Prioritize the weakest problem, user, outcome, or evidence areas before detailed scope work.

NOT READY — INVESTIGATE THE FOUNDATIONS

The idea is still too uncertain in one or more foundational areas. Focus on the problem, primary user, context, and desired outcome before defining features.

Your conclusion

Current judgment (ready / partly ready / not ready)

The single most important uncertainty to resolve

What will you do next before defining the MVP?

From Readiness to MVP Definition

Use the result to choose your next clarification step—not to skip the process.

Suggested next steps

If the problem is unclear
Return to Stage 2 — Problem. Describe it independently of the proposed solution; identify evidence, assumptions, and open questions.

If the primary user is unclear
Work on Stage 3 — User. Define the primary user, context, alternatives, and non-target groups.

If the outcome or value is unclear
Revisit Stage 4 — Value. Connect the user's problem to a meaningful outcome and differentiation.

If the product concept is vague
Work through Stage 5 — Product and Stage 6 — Context & Lifecycle. Clarify the central object, relationships, and lifecycle.

If Core Jobs are unclear
Work on Stage 7 — Core Jobs before prioritizing features in Stage 8 — Scope.

If foundations are reasonably clear
Begin structured clarification across all 15 stages. Keep Market Discovery and Business Model work active.

Working notes

Evidence to gather / people to speak with

Assumptions to test before committing to build

Decision, owner, and review date

Method note: readiness is not proof of product-market fit or a guarantee of success.